

Globally, e-sports is a recognized profession and those who are involved have a huge fan following. In India, the scene has started growing recently, but is already attracting sponsors. ACER, ASUS and MSI – all three are sponsors for the Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup and in fact, ACER and ASUS were associated with the event last year too and have preferred to come onboard for an encore.

After running two extremely successful editions in the last two years, this year, the third stint of the inimitable gaming tournament came to India in a much bigger avatar thanks to an overwhelming response for both the past versions. Says Michael Lin, Director, Taipei World Trade Centre Liaison Office, Mumbai, "Since the last two years, the Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup has gained stupendous popularity in India. In fact, it has garnered such fan-following that gamers were waiting for us to be back with the third edition. Owing to an overwhelming response and demand for more cities, we added four more cities -- Bangalore, Chennai, Hyderabad and Kolkata in addition to Mumbai and Delhi."

Panigrahi says the idea to tie-up with such big games is simple: to provide a platform and encourage more and more avid gamers to come together and compete in gaming tournaments at a professional level, in turn, lending a fillip to the gaming industry. "Such big scale events encourage gamers to take pride in their gaming abilities, and this fans their passion for gaming even more. Professional e-sports has now turned into a source of income, and with good sponsorships it could perhaps follow the model of IPL."

Each year, these leading Taiwanese brands also display the latest offerings from their repertoire at the Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup. Like the past two years, this year too, the grand finale saw an impressive display including sleek tablets, smartphones, gaming technology, leisure related products and travel products. As Jain points out, these events are a great opportunity to reach out to gamers and tell them about their latest launches. "Events like Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup are a big platform for Indian gamers and yes for ASUS ROG as well. The scale of the event is enhanced to reach more and more gamers which helps us to reach out to the gaming community with the newest technology ever seen." ASUS has now even announced their own gaming tournament, the qualifying rounds for which are happening in India.



TAIWAN EXCELLENCE GAMING CUP CREATED HISTORY.



THE BIG SHIFT

In 2013, the Indian gaming industry was worth about \$250 million, which back then did not account for even 1 per cent of the annual global market. But dismissing the fate of the industry based on numbers alone could have been a colossal mistake. There are, of course, a few areas where India is taking rapid strides in the gaming zone. Says Panigrahi, "Consumer demand is definitely the first factor that is playing a direct role in supporting and sustaining the growth of the Indian gaming industry. Another key factor is continuous innovation and reinvention. The gaming industry is booming like never before, thanks to technological advancement and innovation. The opportunities for growth and enhancement are tremendous. Thanks to the increased social acceptance of gaming beyond just a way to kill time, we can see a rise of professional gamers – fuelled by the passion for their sport as well as the desire to compete with the best." He adds that with the right packaging and sponsorship Indian e-sports can really see progress and participation.

IN THE OFFING

Recognising the potential of the Indian gaming industry as well as its gamers, companies have more plans on cards to entice them. ACER has a comprehensive range of gaming products which they say they will continue to invest in -- such as laptops, monitors, projectors, desktops and monitors. "We take a keen interest in the gaming segment as can be seen from our impressive gaming collection – the Predator series, which consists of gaming grade hardware such as the Predator Notebook, monitors, projectors, and so on. We will continue to offer more and more on those lines," says Panigrahi. Jain also further elaborates on ASUS's plans. "ASUS has always been a pioneer in getting something new to the Industry. Just like we launched GX700 Notebook, there are many other developments ASUS would like to introduce to the gamers," he says.

So, if you are an avid gamer, now is your time because gaming has suddenly turned red hot in India just as the action-packed gaming carnival Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup proved while it wrote India's gaming history!